

Product Backlog

Product Backlog

An emergent, ordered list of what is needed to improve the product. The single source of work undertaken by the Scrum Team. The items in the Product Backlog are known as Product Backlog Items.

Goal Set

Items Ordered

Describes: Requirements, Product Backlog Item and Product Goal

Product Backlog Refinement

The ongoing activity of breaking down, and further defining Product Backlog Items into smaller, more precise items (adding detail such as description, order and size). A whole team activity led by the Product Owner.

Requirements

Understand the Requirements and all other competencies

Product Backlog: Goal Set or beyond

Product Backlog Item: Ready

Product Goal: Identified or beyond

Ready Backlog

A Product Backlog is 'ready' if it has enough 'ready' backlog items at its top to fill a Sprint.

Improperly defined backlog items lead to wasted development effort and other delays, which in turn cause the team to miss the Sprint Goal.

Teams should create an objective 'definition of ready' and apply it before placing an item into a Sprint.

Pablo Chisaguano

Sprint Planning

Yesterday's Weather

Use the amount of work done in the last Sprint to forecast the amount of work that can be done in the next Sprint.

Taking just enough work into a Sprint improves team performance.

Sprint Planning

Collaboratively plan the work to be performed in the Sprint and agree what can be delivered in the Sprint's Increment. A whole team event of no more than 8 hours for a one-month Sprint (shorter for shorter Sprints).

Coordinate Activity and all other competencies

Product Goal: Committed (optional)

Sprint: Planned

Sprint Backlog: Actionable Plan in Place or beyond

Sprint Goal: Committed

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Sprint Backlog

Sprint Backlog

A highly visible, real-time picture of the work that the Developers plan to accomplish during the Sprint in order to achieve the Sprint Goal.

Primed with Improvements

Sprint Goal Set

Actionable Plan in Place

Other Detail Captured

Describes: Sprint and Sprint Goal

Interrupt Buffer

For each Sprint allot time for interruptions and do not allow the time to be exceeded.

Research from Carnegie Mellon demonstrates that creating an Interrupt Buffer can enable 42% more points.

If the interrupts overflow the buffer, abort the Sprint.

Paul Villacis

Scrum Master

The Scrum Master is accountable for ensuring that Scrum is understood and enacted. They are true leaders who serve the team in several ways:

• Coaching self-management and cross-functionality

• Removing impediments

• Helping the Product Owner manage the Product Backlog effectively

• Helping the Team focus and create high-value products

• Helping the organization understand and enact Scrum

They are also accountable for the Scrum Team's effectiveness.

Part of: Scrum Team

SPRINT

Sprint

The heartbeat of Scrum, where ideas are turned into value. A time-box of one month or less, a new Sprint starts immediately after the conclusion of the previous Sprint. Regular Sprints create consistency and enable predictability.

Scheduled

Planned

Reviewed

Relates to: Work

Scrumming the Scrum

Definition of Done

A formal description of the state of the increment when it meets the quality measures required for the product. It must be met by all Product Backlog items. If there are multiple Scrum Teams working together on a product they must comply with the same definition of done.

Completion Conditions Listed

Quality Criteria and Evidence Observed

Describes: Way of Working and Product Backlog Item

Scrumming the Scrum

Scrum is about more than just doing the work, it is also about improving the way we work. High-performing Scrum teams make at least one improvement every Sprint. This pattern assures continually increasing efficiency or sustainable high-level work capacity.

Identify the single most important impediment or thing to improve during the Sprint Retrospective. Put it directly into the Sprint Backlog as an improvement and make sure it is done.

Scrum Emergency Procedure

Scrum Emergency Procedure

When unanticipated problems arise that cause the Sprint Goal to slip out of reach, don't wait for the Sprint Review, re-evaluate your plans mid-Sprint and apply the Scrum Emergency Procedure (do only as much as necessary):

1. Innovate / Change the way the work is done

2. Get Help

3. Reduce Scope

4. If all else fails 'Abort the Sprint'

T-Shaped People

T-Shaped People

Scrum teams are cross-functional and require deep functional knowledge across many areas.

T-Shaped people have both the breadth and depth of experience to shape their knowledge to fit the problem, move outside their comfort-zone to learn new skills, and do whatever they can to help their team.

Scrum Teams made up of T-Shaped people have better team-working, flow, predictability and responsiveness than teams of specialists.

Stable Teams

Stable Teams

Stable teams promote effective team-work, increasing collaboration, ownership, accountability and transparency.

If you need predictability, then keep teams stable and avoid shuffling people around.

Note: The work that the team does should also be stable so that the team spends its time working together. Dedicated teams can double productivity.

Daily Scrum

Daily Scrum

Plan and replan the work for the next 24 hours to optimize progress towards the Sprint Goal. A daily, 15-minute event for the Developers (including Scrum Masters and Product Owners actively working on the Sprint Backlog).

Coordinate Activity

Leadership Management

Work Order: Centralize (optional)

Sprint Backlog: Actionable Plan in Place or beyond

Sprint Review

Sprint Review

A working session, held at the end of the Sprint, to inspect the outcome of the Sprint and determine future adaptations. A time-boxed event of no more than 4 hours for a one-month Sprint (shorter for shorter Sprints).

Increment: Product Backlog Items Listed or beyond

Track Progress

Product Backlog: Items Ordered

Product Backlog Item: Identified (optional)

Product Goal: Fulfilled or Abandoned (optional)

Sprint: Reviewed

Sprint Goal: Assessed

Sprint Retrospective

Collaboratively plan and enact ways to increase quality and effectiveness. A Scrum Team event of no more than 3 hours for a one-month Sprint (shorter for shorter Sprints).

Support the Team

Leadership Management and all other competencies

Sprint Backlog: Primed with Improvements (optional)

Definition of Done: Completion Conditions Listed or beyond (optional)

Improvement: Identified or beyond

INCREMENT

Increment

A concrete stepping stone towards the Product Goal. A Sprint may produce multiple Increments. Each Increment is additive to all prior Increments. In order to provide value the Increment must be usable and meet the Definition of Done.

Product Backlog Items Listed

Value Quantified

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